

Home Repair & Energy Upgrade Grants

Need a new roof, furnace, or critical repair you can't afford? Federal and local programs offer grants and very low-interest loans to fix safety hazards and cut your energy bills. Below are the main national programs. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Grants usually go toward health and safety hazards (roof, heating, plumbing, accessibility) — not remodels. Seniors, veterans, and people with disabilities often get priority. A real program never charges a fee just to apply.

1 USDA Repair Help (Rural Homes)

For very-low-income homeowners in rural and many suburban areas. Loans up to \$40,000, plus grants for older homeowners.

☐ USDA Section 504 Home Repair — Loans & Grants

Low-interest (1%) repair loans up to \$40,000. Grants up to \$10,000 for homeowners age 62+ to remove safety hazards. Apply through your local Rural Development office.

→ www.rd.usda.gov/programs-services/single-family-housing-programs/single-family-housing-repair-loans-grants

2 Free Energy Upgrades (Weatherization)

Free improvements — insulation, sealing, sometimes heating repair — that permanently lower your energy bills. No cost to eligible households.

☐ Weatherization Assistance Program (WAP)

Free energy-saving upgrades for income-eligible homes. Priority for seniors, people with disabilities, and families with young kids.

→ www.energy.gov/scep/wap/how-apply-weatherization-assistance

☐ LIHEAP — Heating/Cooling Repair

In many states LIHEAP can help repair or replace a broken furnace or AC. Ask your local agency.

→ www.acf.hhs.gov/ocs/programs/liheap

3 Local Government Repair Programs

Cities and counties run their own owner-occupied repair and rehab programs using federal HUD funds.

☐ HUD HOME & CDBG — Local Rehab Programs

Many local governments offer home-repair grants funded by HUD. Ask your city/county housing department, or a HUD counselor.

→ www.hud.gov/findacounselor

☐ 211 — Local Repair Help

Call or search to find repair grants and programs in your area.

→ www.211.org or dial 211

4 Volunteer & Nonprofit Repair

Charities repair and rebuild homes for free or very low cost, especially for seniors, veterans, and people with disabilities.

☐ Rebuilding Together

Free critical home repairs and accessibility work for low-income homeowners. Find your local affiliate.

→ rebuildingtogether.org

☐ Habitat for Humanity — Home Repair

Many Habitat affiliates offer affordable home repair and weatherization, not just new homes.

→ www.habitat.org/housing-help

☐ VA HISA Grants — Veterans

Home modification grants for veterans with service-connected disabilities (ramps, bathroom safety, accessibility).

→ www.va.gov/housing-assistance/disability-housing-grants

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Watch out for contractors who push you to take a loan or sign over a grant they'll "handle" for you. Apply directly through USDA, your state, or a trusted nonprofit — and never pay a fee just to apply.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Get more than one repair estimate from licensed contractors if a program asks for it. If you need both a repair and an accessibility change, apply for them together — a doctor's or therapist's note can strengthen your case.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized home-repair search

This guide covers the main national programs. For repair grants and weatherization specific to your city, county, or ZIP code, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
